NYC Ride-Hailing Trip Pay

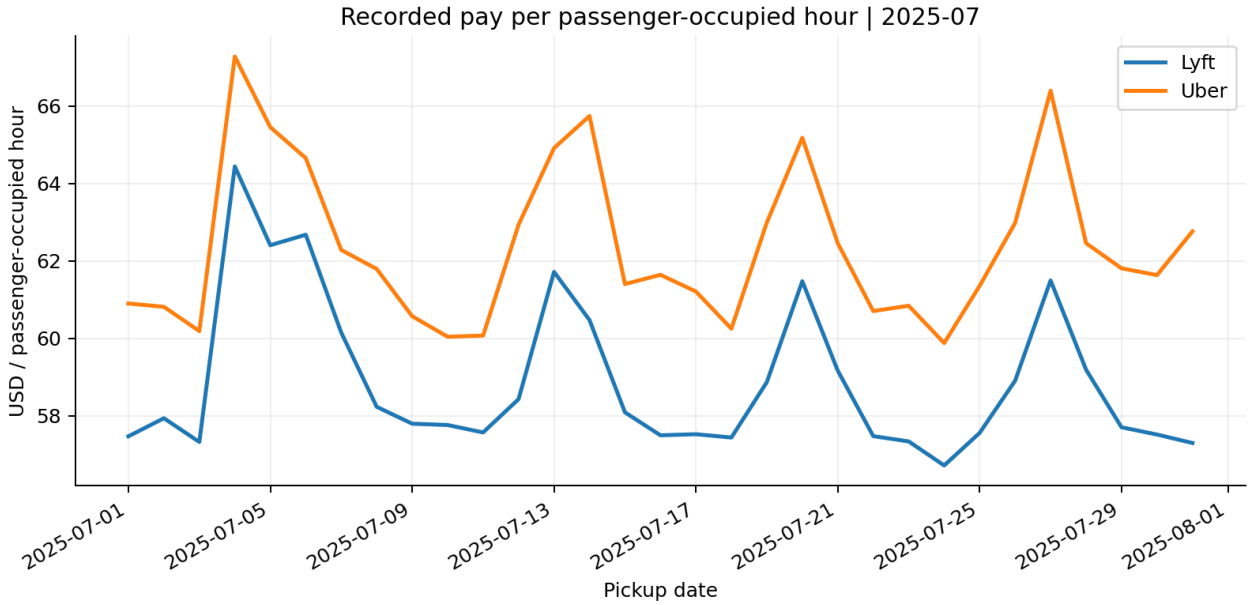
July 2025 | Descriptive analysis | Jonathan Yan

Research question: How does recorded driver pay per passenger-occupied hour vary across platforms and dates, and how sensitive is the description to cleaning and aggregation choices?

The script processed **19,653,012** source records and retained **18,346,549** positive-pay, nonpooled trips with consistent timestamps, known destinations, and NYC origins.

Platform	Retained trips	Pay / occupied hour	Pay / mile
Lyft	5,261,503	$58.80	$4.21
Uber	13,085,046	$62.29	$4.28

These are not hourly wages. The denominator includes passenger-trip time only; waiting, pickup travel, and operating expenses are absent. Platform differences are unadjusted for trip and vehicle composition.



Checks and limitations. Duration/speed screening changes each aggregate hourly figure by less than $0.01. A five-minute minimum gives $58.69 for Lyft and $62.11 for Uber. The geography filter excludes 928,254 records; pooling status excludes another 368,990. This is a coverage restriction, not a claim that every excluded record is wrong.

No driver IDs or online histories: this project cannot measure driver supply, within-driver volatility, lockouts, take-home pay, policy effects, or legal violations. No statistical or causal significance is claimed.

Sources: NYC TLC July 2025 HVFHV trip records and official HVFHV data dictionary. Reproduction code, source hashes, complete cleaning counts, and all specifications are included in the repository.